Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI61 61% Fe Fines RMB/t

775
-2 -0.26%
Apr 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

934
-2.00 -0.21%
Apr 21st, 2026

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

712
-1 -0.14%
Apr 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI61 61% Fe Fines USD/dmt

107.75
-0.09 -0.08%
Apr 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

125.75
-0.05 -0.04%
Apr 21st, 2026

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

897
17 1.93%
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2609 RMB/t (3pm close)

784.00
-2.50 -0.32%
Apr 21st, 2026 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
May 26 USD/dmt

106.90
-0.05 -0.05%
Apr 21st, 2026 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2610 RMB/t

3176
4 0.13%
Apr 21st, 2026 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

32.88
0.42 1.3%
Apr 20th, 2026

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

13.71
0.14 1.0%
Apr 20th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3150
23 0.74%
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

152.58
-0.61 -0.40%
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

13.47
-0.49 -3.51%
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3319
44 1.36%
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Apr 21st, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	775	-2	-0.3%	787	826	683	1063	104.75	-0.20	-0.2%	102.74	107.98	89.33	140.24
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	712	-1	-0.1%	695	727	610	963	96.97	-0.07	-0.1%	91.32	95.63	80.25	128.13
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	934	-2	-0.2%	899	938	794	1175	127.05	-0.18	-0.1%	117.88	123.10	104.47	155.37

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Apr 21st, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	107.75	-0.09	-0.08%	103.67	108.97	89.79	142.65
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	125.75	-0.05	-0.04%	116.23	123.74	98.23	171.65

MARKET COMMENTARY

Today's iron ore market trended higher before easing off. The most active contract i2609 closed at 784 yuan/tonne, up 0.64% from the previous session.

Spot prices edged down by 0–2 yuan/tonne day-on-day. Traders maintained active quotations, while steel mills made restocking purchases on an as-needed basis; overall spot trading volume remained light.

In terms of fundamentals, this week's survey shows that blast furnace maintenance reduced hot metal output by 1.2625 million tonnes, a decrease of 50,000 tonnes week-on-week. Output is expected to fall by a further 1,000 tonnes next week. Overall demand remains firm, with resilient rigid demand for iron ore, providing relatively stable downside support for iron ore prices.

On the news front, market rumors suggested that previously restricted port inventories were expected to be released this week, but no further updates have emerged so far. Amid risk and price considerations, market participants have adopted a strong wait-and-see stance.

Therefore, in the short term, absent new developments, iron ore prices are expected to remain range-bound at high levels. If the previously restricted inventories are released, they may weigh on iron ore prices and trigger a short-term weakening.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	897	17	1.9%	895	950	820	1210	116.74	2.43	2.13%	112.42	119.53	102.77	153.57

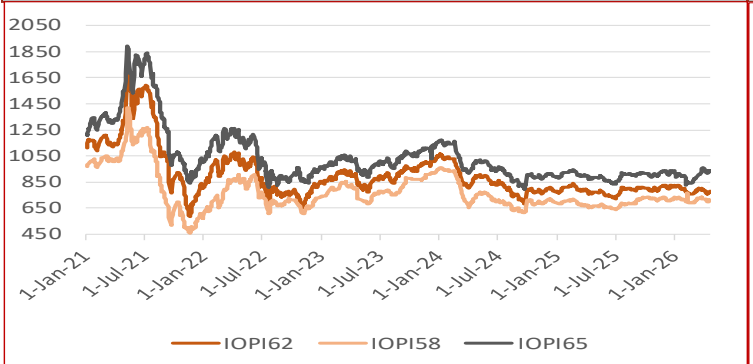
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	962	-1.4%	859	1226	140.20	-1.30%	119.88	172.59
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	975	0.0%	880	1300	142.10	0.14%	122.81	183.23
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	745	0.0%	690	970	108.58	0.14%	96.49	136.72
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	994	-1.6%	878	1294	144.87	-1.45%	122.53	182.16

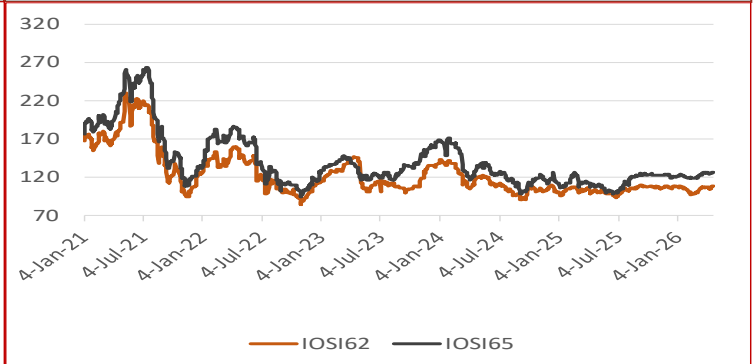
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	881.90	-0.16%	802.20	905.40

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 7.191 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =7.19258

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Apr 21st, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	798	810	769	787	787	782	826	100.24	107.43	102.60	105.74	102.74	102.14	107.98
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	716	719	699	716	695	690	727	94.72	96.04	93.94	96.95	91.32	90.65	95.63
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	925	900	852	906	899	894	938	122.17	119.85	114.11	122.37	117.88	117.28	123.10

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Apr 21st, 2026		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	105.42	106.27	99.65	104.52	103.67	103.02	108.97
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	121.09	121.51	118.61	123.28	116.23	115.40	123.74

FREIGHT RATES

Apr 20th, 2026		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	13.71	0.14	1.0%	5.92	14.89
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	32.88	0.42	1.3%	16.08	35.02

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	864	875	844	894	895	891	950	110.83	111.50	108.31	115.65	112.42	112.02	119.53

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Apr 21st, 2026		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-63	-8.13%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	159	20.52%

Apr 21st, 2026		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	18.00	16.71%

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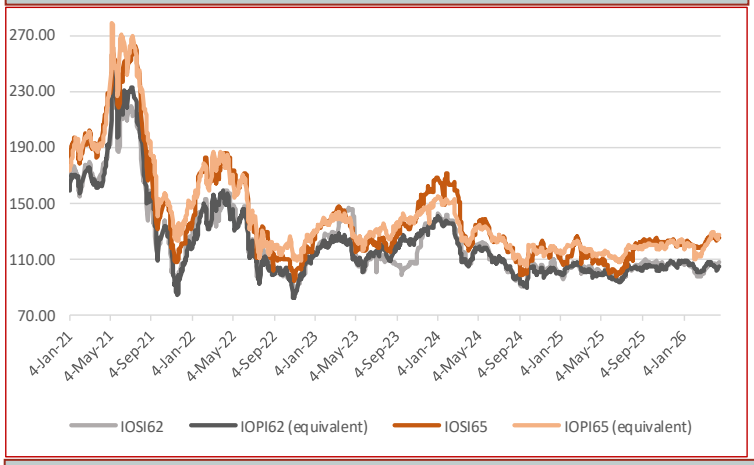
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Apr 21st, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	718	-10	-57
SIMEC Fines	729	-22	-46
PB Fines	794	-7	19
Newman Fines	791	-2	16
MAC Fines	766	-5	-9
Jimblebar Blended Fines	706	0	-69
Carajas Fines	904	-25	129
Brazilian SSF	812	-44	37
Brazilian Blend Fines	840	-22	65
RTX Fines	722	16	-53
West Pilbara Fines	754	-11	-21

Apr 21st, 2026	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	100.20	-0.20	-7.55
SIMEC Fines	95.00	-0.20	-12.75
PB Fines	107.45	-0.15	-0.30
Newman Fines	101.80	-0.10	-5.95
MAC Fines	101.30	-0.10	-6.45
Jimblebar Blended Fines	96.95	-0.05	-10.80
Carajas Fines	125.50	-0.10	17.75
Brazilian SSF	103.40	-0.10	-4.35
Brazilian Blend Fines	113.05	-0.15	5.30
RTX Fines	97.00	0.00	-10.75
West Pilbara Fines	98.10	-0.10	-9.65

Apr 21st, 2026	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	712	45	0
FMG Blended Fines	722	-5	10
Robe River	722	-7	10
Western Fines	724	26	12
Atlas Fines	719	-10	7
Yandi	701	0	-11

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	19.00	-1.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	24.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	30.00	-5.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	66.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	35.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	10.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	15.00	-4.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	27.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	27.00	4.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	6.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	7.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	7.75	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	6.75	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	1.75	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-20.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-18.00	0.00	Lianyungang	-3.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-15.00	0.00	Jingtang	-16.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-18.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-15.00	0.00

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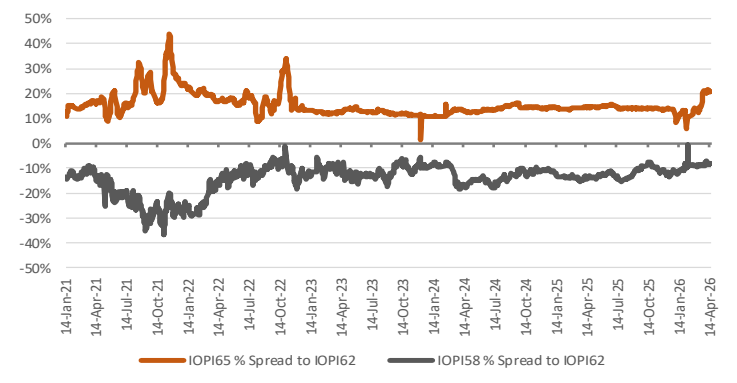
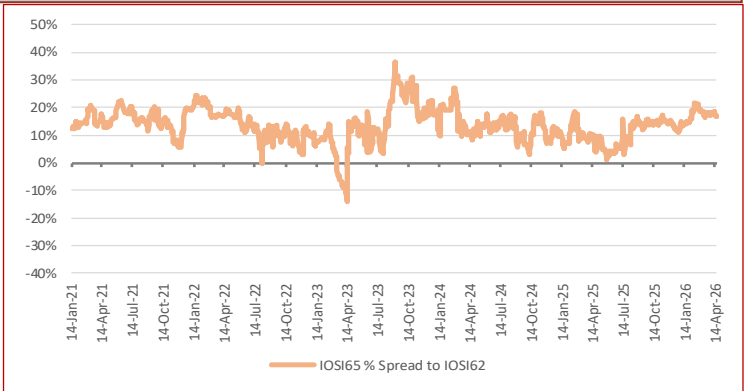
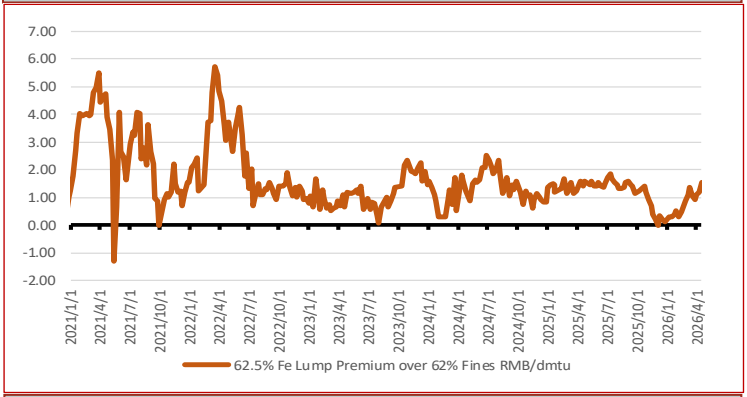
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

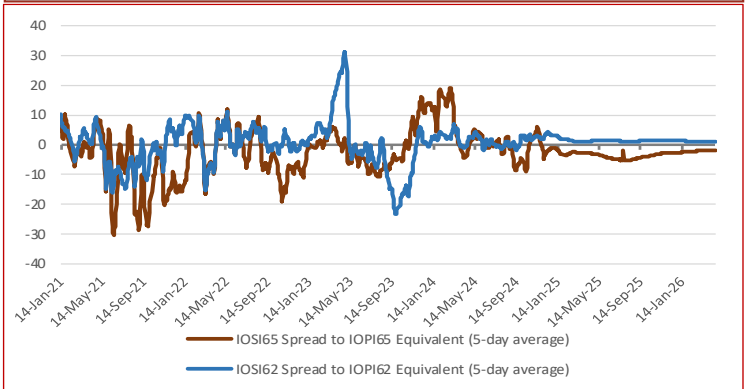




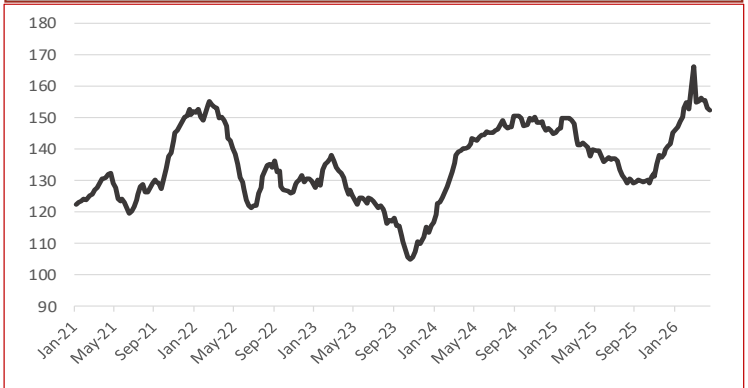
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



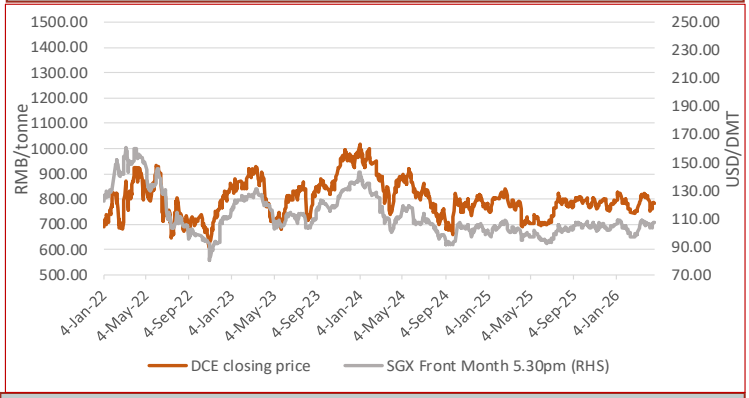
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

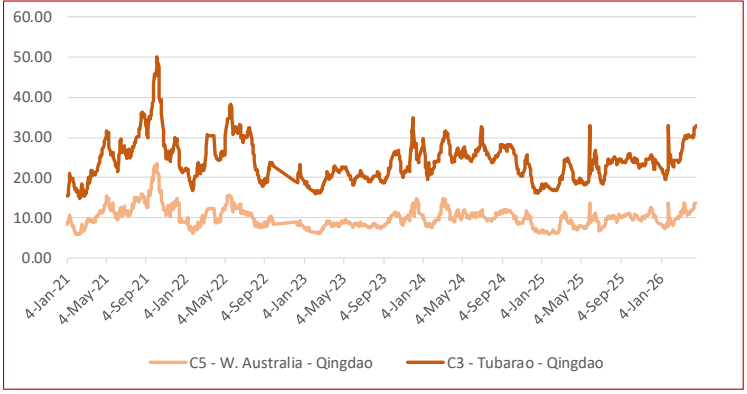
Week Ending Apr 17th, 2026

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	18.53	-1.01%	8.29	19.04
Qingdao	31.01	-0.39%	22.28	34.83
Caofeidian	17.55	-0.50%	7.56	20.28
Tianjin	12.60	-0.79%	6.64	12.70
Rizhao	10.20	-4.40%	10.20	21.35
Total (35 Ports)	152.58	-0.40%	105.01	166.39

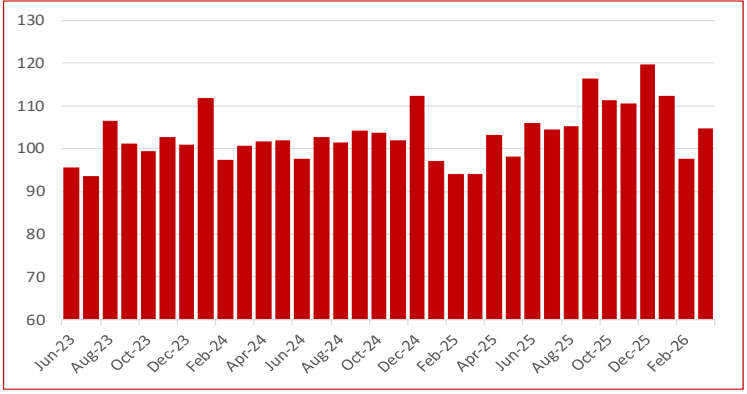
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Apr 21st, 3pm close			Apr 21st, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2609	Change	Change %	May. 26	Change	Change %
Closing Price	784.00	-2.50	-0.32%	106.90	-0.05	-0.05%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	17.90	-11.14	-38.37%	7.99	-2.41	-23.19%
Open positions ('000 lots)	53.28	1.27	2.45%	56.73	-0.31	-0.54%
Day Low	780.5	10.00	1.30%	106.35	2.10	2.01%
Day High	787.5	-1.50	-0.19%	107.05	0.05	0.05%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2026/04/17	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,150	23	0.74%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,358	25	0.75%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,319	44	1.36%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	3,773	10	0.27%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,420	20	0.59%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,030	10	0.25%
Colour Coated Plate	6,300	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

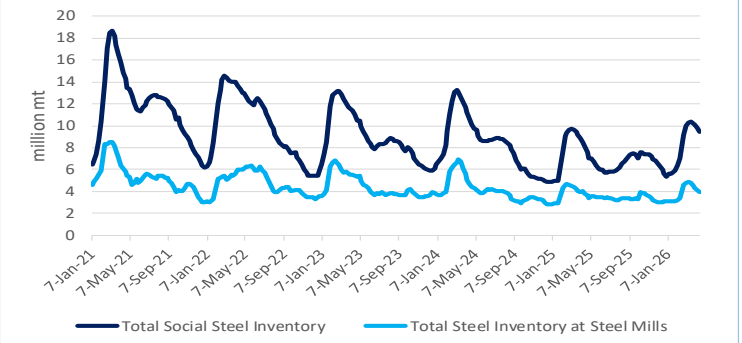
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	103.94	1.71	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	1,660	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,450	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	2,570	19	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,130	22	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-10	-2	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,200	20	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	120	30	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

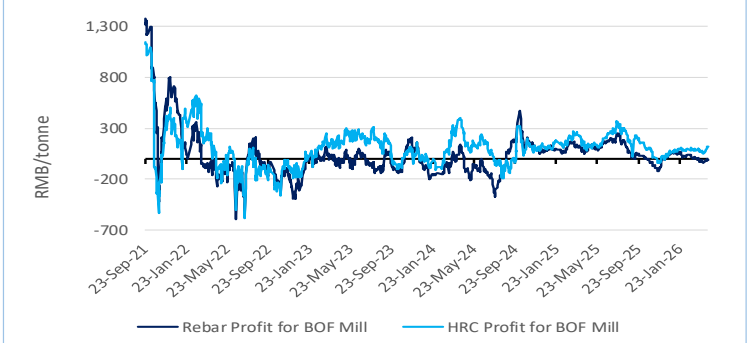
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

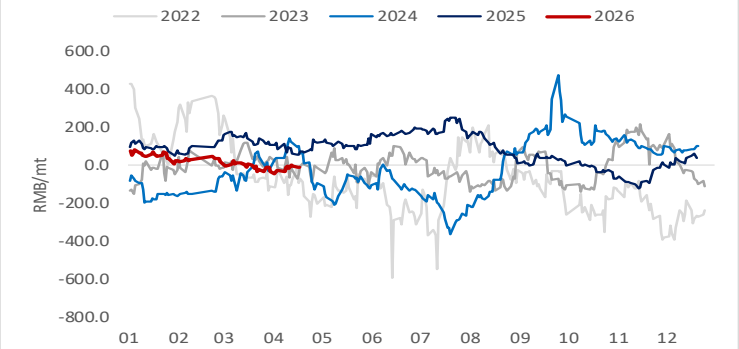
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



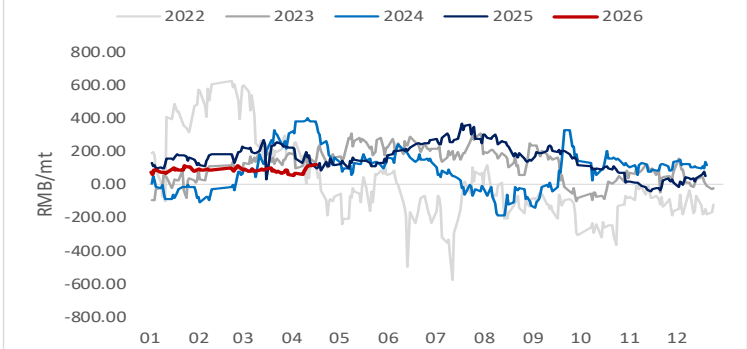
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



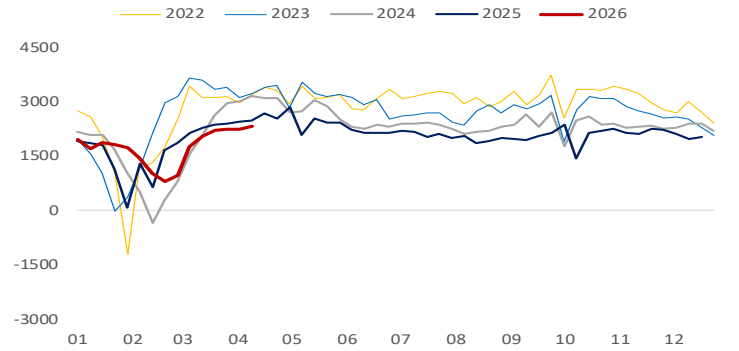
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



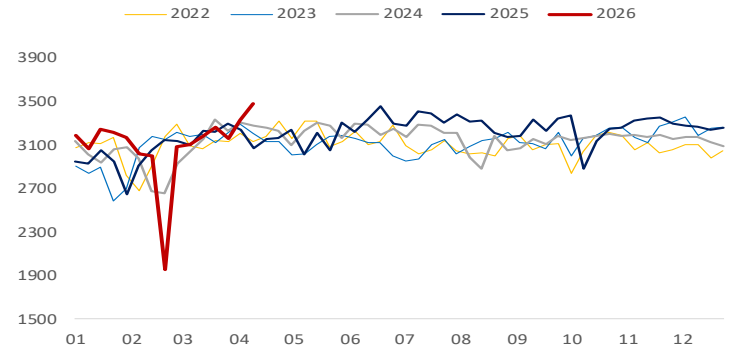
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



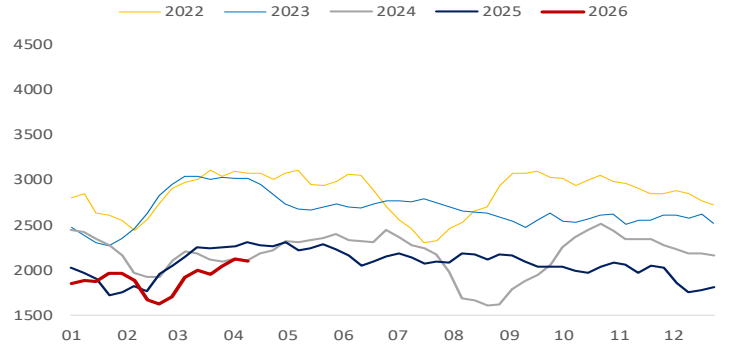
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



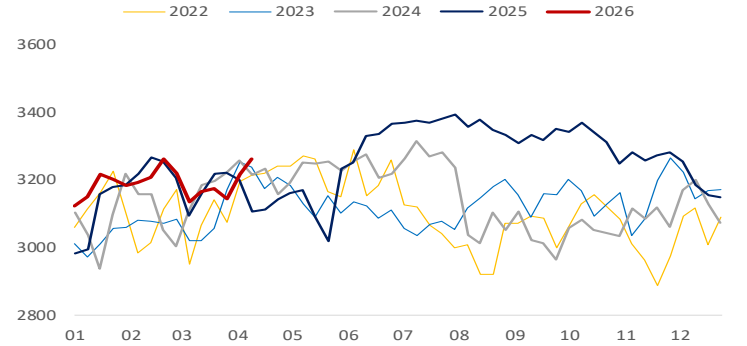
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Apr 21st, 2026	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Apr 21st, 2026	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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